

The 100 Laws of Elite Smart App Interfaces

NayaNET / NayaPOWER — Canonical Standard Locked in place for every Smart App, every Hub page, every board, button, icon, and element.

Prime directive: Premium, not fancy. Living depth, always. Zero flat.

This is the Lego library law. If an element exists in NayaNET, it has a block here. If it has no block, we build the block before we build the app. Any Naya, any seat, any cold successor must be able to pick up this document and build an elite interface without re-asking Shawn the same questions.

How to use this document

- **Before building:** Read Laws 1–20. They are non-negotiable.
 - **While building:** Use only canonical blocks. One button system, one board system, one icon family.
 - **Before shipping:** Run the Acceptance Checklist at the end. Screenshot at desktop, tablet, and phone. Score honestly. Below 9.0 does not ship to Shawn.
 - **When Shawn corrects:** The correction becomes a new law or sharpens an old one — same day, in this file.
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I. Elevation & Living Depth — Laws 1–10

Law 1 — Elevation always. Every button, every board, every card, all the time. If it does not sit off the page, it is not finished. Flat is a defect, not a style.

Law 2 — No 2D in NayaNET. There is no flat plane. Every interactive surface has at least three layers: base surface, edge light, seating shadow. Non-interactive surfaces have at least two.

Law 3 — Living depth. Depth is not a static shadow. On hover, focus, or approach, the element lifts, its edge catches light, and its shadow deepens. The element feels alive — we call this *Active Intelligence*.

Law 4 — Shadow is weight. A heavier shadow means a more important element. Primary actions cast the deepest shadow; tertiary elements cast the lightest. Shadow hierarchy = action hierarchy.

Law 5 — The page is a physical space. Elements exist *on* the page, not *in* it. A board overlapping another board must resolve with elevation, not z-index tricks. If it looks pasted on, rebuild it.

Law 6 — Depth before color. Establish the elevation system in black and white first. If it does not read as premium in monochrome, color will not save it.

Law 7 — Seating shadow, never drop shadow. Use a soft, offset, dark seating shadow that grounds the element. Never a uniform blur halo — that reads as glow, not weight.

Law 8 — Edge light is a hairline. The top edge catches a 1px highlight at 12–20% white. The sides fade. The bottom edge is shadow. This is how real objects catch light.

Law 9 — Inner depth counts. Recessed wells (inputs, code blocks, media players) are carved *into* the page with inner shadow. Raised and recessed are the only two directions. Nothing is level with the page.

Law 10 — If it doesn't move, it's dead. Every board and button responds to pointer proximity. No response = no good. Ship the hover state with the element, not after it.

II. Premium Material & Contrast — Laws 11–20

Law 11 — Premium, not fancy. Fancy is effects. Premium is material, contrast, weight, and restraint. When in doubt, subtract. A button that whispers is more expensive than one that shouts.

Law 12 — Deep black is the base. Default surface: rich obsidian (#0a0a0f to #12121a range). Not gray, not navy, not purple-tinted. Black is the canvas; color is the jewel set into it.

Law 13 — Contrast is a law, not a preference. Body text on its surface must pass WCAG AA at minimum, AAA preferred. If you have to squint, it fails. Red on red, purple on purple, gold on yellow — automatic rejection.

Law 14 — Glow lives on the border, not in the air. Accent glow is a tight border light-up: 0–4px spread, high precision. Outward bloom beyond 8px reads as cheap neon. The board lights up; it does not radiate.

Law 15 — White glow requires blacker black. If a white or silver glow is used, the surface beneath must be deepened first. Glow on mid-gray washes out. Contrast first, glow second.

Law 16 — Luxury is restraint. One accent per element. One jewel per board. The moment everything glows, nothing is premium. Empty black space is a design material.

Law 17 — Text is printed, not rendered. Type must look like it was set by a master printer: crisp antialiasing, intentional weight, no text-shadow blur. If text looks like a screenshot of text, the weight or size is wrong.

Law 18 — Materials have names. We use: Obsidian (base), Frosted Obsidian (translucent panels), Jewel (accent surfaces), Paper White (text), Silver (secondary text). Inventing a new

material per page is forbidden.

Law 19 — The most expensive element test. Look at the page. Every element should be a candidate for "most expensive thing here." If one element visibly cheapens the page, it is the page's quality ceiling. Fix it or remove it.

Law 20 — Subtract before adding. "10x better" means better human experience, not more effects (SN-0733). Before adding a gradient, animation, or glow, ask: does removing something make this more premium? Usually yes.

III. Buttons — The Jewel Standard — Laws 21–30

Law 21 — One canonical button. `.naya-btn` is the only button system. All variants derive from it. A second button implementation on the same page is a consistency violation, not a creative choice.

Law 22 — The three front-door buttons set the bar. The first three actions a user sees are the flagship component. They must be the most polished controls in the product. If a Smart Tab button looks more professional than the hero button, the hero button fails.

Law 23 — Black body, jewel accent. Buttons are deep black with a jewel-toned accent: hairline border, kicker text, icon, or edge light. Never a full-color fill for body text or large surfaces. Color is the setting, not the stone.

Law 24 — Five mandatory states. Rest, Hover, Press, Focus, Disabled — plus Loading and Success where the action is async. Missing a state means the button is unfinished. Press compresses 1–2px; hover lifts 2–4px.

Law 25 — A circle flows around it. Icon buttons and primary CTAs may carry a rotating or flowing ring accent on hover — a thin jewel line that travels the perimeter. It signals life without bloom. Keep it under 2px and under 40% opacity.

Law 26 — Delete is dark, not glowing red. Destructive actions use deep black with a desaturated red accent (border, icon, or text at rest). Glowing red hover is forbidden — it reads as alarm, not elegance. Confirmation does the safety work, not the glow.

Law 27 — Labels are verbs, one line. "Create", "Publish", "Connect", "Save". sentence case, no period, no exclamation. A label that wraps to two lines means the copy or the button width is wrong.

Law 28 — Minimum touch target 44×44px. Every button, everywhere, no exceptions (mobile-first law). Visual size may be smaller only if the hit area is not. Desktop density never overrides touch law.

Law 29 — Buttons in a row are a family. Same height, same radius, same depth system. The primary is elevated highest; secondaries sit one step lower. A row of mismatched buttons reads as three different products.

Law 30 — Never re-teach the button. When Shawn approves a button, that exact code becomes the block (SN-0735: take the actual code). Rebuilding it "from memory" next time is how flat buttons come back. Copy the block verbatim, then vary only the variant class.

IV. Boards, Cards & Panels — Laws 31–40

Law 31 — The board recipe. Dark obsidian body, theme-tinted hairline edge, rich radial wash confined to the cover/header zone, white title, silver body text, jewel kicker. This recipe is not optional decoration — it is the board.

Law 32 — The outer board is alive too. Hovering a board lights its border and lifts the whole board, not just inner elements. A dead outer board with live buttons inside is a half-finished board.

Law 33 — Black board, colored border. Boards are black first. The spectrum color lives in the border, the kicker, the badge, and the hover edge-light — never as a full purple/red/green wash over the whole surface.

Law 34 — Glow stays in the frame. Board glow = border illumination only. Light does not spill more than 6px outside the frame. Spill washes out neighboring boards and destroys the "jewels on black velvet" effect.

Law 35 — Elevation hierarchy on the page. Page background (deepest) → section panels (+1) → boards (+2) → featured board (+3) → modal (+4). Never more than five levels visible at once. If everything is elevated equally, nothing is.

Law 36 — "In a nutshell / How to use it" panels are boards too. Explanatory panels, spec panels, and help blocks get the same elevation, border, and hover life as content boards. Flat instructional text on the page background is forbidden.

Law 37 — Headline / Body / Detail are a system. Every board carries three type levels: headline (white, largest), body (silver, readable), detail (muted, smallest but never below 12px). Skipping the body level collapses comprehension.

Law 38 — Boards breathe. Minimum 16px internal padding, 20–24px preferred. Content touching the border is a layout bug. Crowded boards read as cheap regardless of color.

Law 39 — Adjacent boards never share a color. Spectrum is assigned by position in the flow (see Section V), not by category. Two same-color boards side by side is a Spectrum Law violation.

Law 40 — The green/gold/pink test. Claimed/demonstrated state cards (green = verified, gold = premium, pink/magenta = featured) are the reference implementation. If a new board type does not feel like it belongs in that set, it is not done.

V. Color, Spectrum & Jewels — Laws 41–50

Law 41 — Spectrum by position. Purple → indigo → sapphire → teal → emerald → lime → yellow → gold → orange → rich orange → red → magenta → repeat. Assign in reading order. Theming by category clumps color and is a serious violation.

Law 42 — Jewel colors are for jewels, never text fills. Lime body text, gold paragraphs, red labels on red — forbidden. Jewels live in: hairline borders, number badges, checkmarks, kickers, icons, edge lights. Small, glowing, precious.

Law 43 — LAW ZERO: Readability Supremacy. No glow, gradient, accent, or depth effect may ever make anything harder to read. If an effect and readability conflict, the effect dies. Generous text by default.

Law 44 — Black with accents beats all-color. A black board with a teal edge is more premium than a teal board. Default to black; spend color like money.

Law 45 — One spectrum step per board. A board owns one spectrum position. Its jewel accent, kicker, and hover light all derive from that single hue (plus white/silver neutrals). Rainbow boards are for the Smart Feed spine only.

Law 46 — Red is a jewel, not a surface. Red appears as: delete accent, error indicator, notification badge, the spectrum's red step border. A red-filled board or red-on-red button (faded numeral on red) fails contrast and fails Law 13.

Law 47 — Gold means precious, use sparingly. Gold/yellow is restrained: premium badges, verified marks, the gold spectrum step. Never body text, never large fills. Gold everywhere is not luxury; it is a casino.

Law 48 — Neutrals do the heavy lifting. White (titles, primary text), silver (body), slate (detail), obsidian (surfaces). If a page is more than ~20% saturated color by area, rebalance toward black and neutrals.

Law 49 — Dark mode is the mode. NayaNET is designed dark-first. Light surfaces, where needed, must be designed as their own premium material — never an inverted afterthought.

Law 50 — Color survives the screenshot test. Take a screenshot, convert to grayscale. Hierarchy, elevation, and readability must survive. If the page only works in color, the depth system is fake.

VI. Typography & Readability — Laws 51–60

Law 51 — White titles, silver body, always. Titles in white, body in silver, detail in muted slate. No exceptions for "creative" color text. Jewel color in a kicker (small, uppercase, tracked) is the only colored text allowed.

Law 52 — Type scale is fixed. Display 32–40 / Headline 22–28 / Body 15–17 / Detail 12–13 / Kicker 11 uppercase. Inventing sizes per page fragments the system. Line-height 1.45–1.6 for body.

Law 53 — Readability outranks density. If fitting more content means smaller text or tighter leading, fit less content. A board that breathes beats a board that crams.

Law 54 — Serif for voice, sans for system. Display headlines and the Naya voice may use the premium serif. UI labels, buttons, data, and body use the system sans. Never set body copy in display serif.

Law 55 — Numbers are designed. Badges, counts, and stats use tabular numerals, optically centered in their jewel badge. A faded number on a same-color button (red 6 on red) is invisible and forbidden — contrast or remove.

Law 56 — Truncation is a design decision. Ellipsize with intent, provide the full text on tap/hover, never let text overflow its board or push layout sideways. Overflow on mobile is a P0 bug.

Law 57 — Grandma standard. A non-technical reader must follow every board: what is this, what matters, what do I do next? If they cannot, the copy or hierarchy fails — not the reader (Ten-Star Service law).

Law 58 — No text on busy backgrounds. Text sits on solid obsidian or a controlled scrim. Text over gradients, images, or glows without a scrim fails Law 43.

Law 59 — Weight creates hierarchy before size does. Bold white headline > regular white > silver > slate. Reach for weight and color-value contrast before making type bigger.

Law 60 — Every label earns its place. If deleting a label costs the reader no action and no interpretation, delete it. Decorative text is noise wearing a uniform.

VII. Icons & Micro-Elements — The Full Library — Laws 61–70

Law 61 — One icon family. Consistent stroke weight, corner treatment, optical size. Mixing icon sets is mixing languages. Drawn at size, never shrunk from a large illustration.

Law 62 — The library is complete before apps begin. Required blocks, each with rest/hover/active/disabled states: Like (heart), Share, Plus/Add, Play, Pause, Search, Bell/Notify,

Bookmark/Save, Comment, More (⋯), Close, Back, Check/Verified, Star/Premium, Send, Download, External Link, Settings, Profile, Lock/Private, Globe/Public.

Law 63 — Icon buttons are circles with life. Circular hit area, black surface, jewel icon, border light-up and lift on hover. The circle may carry the flowing ring (Law 25). A bare glyph with no surface is not a NayaNET icon button.

Law 64 — Like is a jewel, not a emoji. Like/heart fills with its spectrum jewel on activation, with a micro-scale pulse. Share uses the connected-nodes glyph. Plus sits in an elevated circle — it is the most-tapped element in creation flows and must feel premium.

Law 65 — Play is a portal. Media play buttons are elevated circles with a white triangle, black field, jewel ring. On hover the ring lights; on press it compresses. PowerCast and all media inherit this block — no custom play buttons per page.

Law 66 — Badges sit on black. Notification counts, status dots, and verified marks sit on an obsidian chip with a jewel numeral/symbol. Never a colored disc with a same-color numeral.

Law 67 — Icons have text names. Every icon-only control carries an accessible label and, where space allows, a visible micro-label. Mystery-meat navigation is forbidden.

Law 68 — State is visible at a glance. Liked/not, saved/not, following/not, live/not — each state is distinguishable by fill, weight, and jewel presence, not by color alone (colorblind-safe pairing).

Law 69 — Micro-elements get macro care. Toggles, checkboxes, radio pills, sliders, and segmented controls use the same elevation, edge-light, and press physics as primary buttons. A default browser control in a NayaNET app is a leak in the system.

Law 70 — Avatars are jewels too. Profile images sit in a ringed, elevated circular frame with a spectrum or status edge. A square naked `<img>` is not a profile element.

VIII. Motion & Living Intelligence — Laws 71–80

Law 71 — Everything alive responds in under 100ms. Hover, press, and focus feedback begins instantly. A press that registers late feels broken even if the action succeeds.

Law 72 — The signature ease. `.22s cubic-bezier(.16,.84,.22,1)` for lifts and lights. Snappy in, gentle settle. Different easing per page fragments the feel of the product.

Law 73 — Press is compression. On press, the element settles 1–2px toward the page and its shadow tightens. Release springs it back. This single behavior sells physicality more than any gradient.

Law 74 — Light travels, it doesn't blink. Edge light sweeps or fades in along the border; it never hard-toggles. Cursor-tracking spotlight on flagship buttons is allowed — subtle, warm, and it dies the moment it distracts (Law 20).

Law 75 — Loading is honest. Spinners, skeletons, and progress reflect real work. A success state appears only when the action actually succeeded. Fake success is a trust violation (Functional Truth).

Law 76 — Motion explains, never decorates. Every animation answers: what changed, where did it go, what can I do now? Animation that answers nothing gets cut.

Law 77 — Respect reduced motion. `prefers-reduced-motion` disables lifts, rings, and sweeps; state still changes via light and contrast. Accessibility is not a variant; it is the same product, honored.

Law 78 — Breathing is reserved. Slow ambient pulse is allowed only on the single most-alive element per view (e.g., the voice orb, live indicator). Three breathing buttons in a row is a screensaver, not an interface.

Law 79 — Transitions between views are spatial. Boards slide, fade, and elevate in the direction of navigation. A hard cut between app views reads as a page reload — the old internet. Smart Apps move like objects in one space.

Law 80 — Alive at rest, brilliant on approach. At rest: quiet white/silver, black, restrained. On hover/active: the board's jewel lights. Rest/ignite is the rhythm of the whole system — never monochrome dead, never neon at rest.

IX. Mobile-First & Touch — Laws 81–90

Law 81 — Mobile is the primary canvas. We build smart mobile apps that also work on laptop — never desktop pages shrunk down. Design, screenshot, and score the phone view first.

Law 82 — Extraordinary on both, equal quality. Laptop gets the same elevation, jewel, and motion system, expanded spatially. Mobile gets its own composition, not a squeezed column of the desktop layout.

Law 83 — 44px is the floor, 48px is the target. All touch targets (buttons, icons, tabs, list rows) meet Law 28. Legacy elements under 44px are defects to batch-fix, not styles to preserve.

Law 84 — Tap mirrors hover. Every `:hover` has an `:active` twin. A phone user must feel the same lift/light/compress physics through touch. Hover-only delight is desktop-only exclusion.

Law 85 — No horizontal scroll, ever. Content fits the viewport width at 360px. Fixed bottom bars must reserve padding so they never cover content. Cut-off text or sideways scroll is a P0 release

blocker.

Law 86 — Safe areas are respected. Notch, gesture bar, and home indicator insets are padded. Boards and bars never slide under hardware.

Law 87 — Bottom navigation is real buttons. Nav items are elevated, labeled, jewel-active-state blocks from the canonical library. Blank circles or naked glyphs in a bottom bar fail Law 63 and Law 67.

Law 88 — Thumb-first layout. Primary action within thumb reach on phone. Destructive actions never adjacent to primary actions in the thumb zone.

Law 89 — Inputs are boards. Form fields are recessed obsidian wells (Law 9) with jewel focus border, 16px text (prevents iOS zoom), visible label, and inline validation state. A white default input ends the premium spell.

Law 90 — Test on real viewports. Phone (390×844), small phone (360×800), tablet (768×1024), laptop (1440×900). Screenshots at each. "It looked fine in the browser resize" is not evidence.

X. Consistency, Library & Proof — Laws 91–100

Law 91 — One library, one DNA. Buttons, boards, icons, inputs, tabs, modals, toasts, tables, navigation — each element exists once, canonically. Pages consume blocks; they do not reinvent them. A page with a private button class is drift.

Law 92 — Take the actual code (SN-0735). Approved elements are extracted line-by-line into the library. Paraphrasing approved CSS from memory reintroduces the exact flatness Shawn rejected. The block is the memory.

Law 93 — The machine-readable contract. Design laws ship as a machine-readable design contract (tokens: colors, elevation steps, spacing, type scale, motion) that every page and every report generator reads. A law that lives only in a chat is a law that will be broken by the next pipeline (SN-0733 lineage).

Law 94 — Scorecard before showing Shawn. Every page is scored on: Buttons, Boards, Typography, Icons, Motion, Color/Material, Layout, Mobile, Accessibility, Functional Truth. Per-area floor 9.0; nothing below 9.0 is presented. Name what is not a 10 and why.

Law 95 — Screenshot or it didn't happen. Delivery includes timestamped screenshots (desktop + mobile) of the actual file shipped, with hash/size. Claiming "elevated" without a hover-state screenshot is an assertion, not evidence.

Law 96 — The cold-Naya graduation test (SN-0731). A fresh Naya, given only this document and the library, must build a Smart App scoring 9.5+ independently, with instruction-repetition

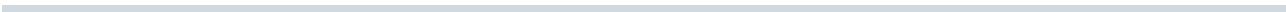
counted. If it needs Shawn to re-teach a law, the law or the block is incomplete — fix the system, not the student.

Law 97 — Corrections compound the same day. Every Shawn correction is distilled into this document or the library within the same session. A correction that lives only in chat will be re-taught by Shawn next week — that repetition is our defect, not his.

Law 98 — Never ship the same flaw twice (SN-0734). If a rebuild goes flatter than what Shawn loved, revert to the loved version verbatim and rebuild from there. No-ego reversion beats stubborn iteration.

Law 99 — Audit every page against this standard. Connect, Connections, Index, Ledger, Library, Lists, Mail, Reports, Spaces, Start, Today — and every future Smart App — are audited law-by-law. Already good stays untouched; anything below standard gets upgraded. There are no exempt pages.

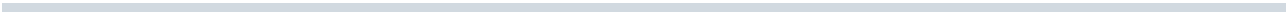
Law 100 — 10x better than the best, by experience. The target is not Apple, Linear, or Stripe — it is the felt experience those never delivered: a living, intelligent surface that remembers, responds, and feels like a jewel in the hand. Define "better" as the human experience first (Law 20), then build. Shawn's eye is the ground truth; the scorecard is the hypothesis.



Quick reference — Do / Don't



Do	Don't
Elevate every board & button	Ship flat panels or labels as buttons
Black body, jewel border/kicker	Full-color board fills
Border light-up, tight glow	Outward neon bloom
White title, silver body	Jewel-colored body text
Spectrum by position in flow	Same color by category, clumped
44px+ touch targets	28px legacy tap areas
Press = compress & settle	No press state
One canonical <code>.naya-btn</code>	A new button class per page
Dark delete, red accent only	Glowing red delete hover
Screenshot desktop + mobile	"It's done" without proof



Acceptance checklist (per page)

- All buttons are `.naya-btn` variants; zero legacy button classes remain
- Every board lifts and lights its border on hover; state boards included
- No element is flat: elevation step assigned to every surface
- Spectrum assigned by position; no adjacent boards share a color
- Contrast spot-check: no same-hue text-on-fill anywhere (esp. badges)
- All icon buttons from Law 62 library, circular, labeled
- All touch targets $\geq 44\text{px}$; `:active` mirrors every `:hover`
- No horizontal scroll at 360px; bottom bar never covers content
- Inputs, modals, toasts, nav use canonical blocks (Law 91)
- Scored ≥ 9.0 per area with screenshots attached (Law 94–95)

Missing blocks — build order

The library is not complete until these exist as canonical blocks:

1. Input / form block (Law 89)
2. Modal & dialog block
3. Toast / notification block
4. Data table block
5. Search interface block
6. Toggle / settings block
7. Content card block (distinct from board)
8. Media player block (Law 65)
9. Chart / data-viz block
10. Smart Link / share sheet block

Each block ships with: code, states, do/don't example, and a screenshot. A block without a screenshot is a draft.

Distilled from Shawn's teachings 2026-09-30 → 2026-10-08: premium not fancy, elevation always, living depth, Spectrum Law, LAW ZERO, Button Law, mobile-first, the \$10-trillion-button standard, and SN-0731/0733/0734/0735. Corrections to this document go through Shawn; ratification is his word.